HireOrGetHired — Submission Report

Agentic AI Platform for Recruitment & Career Intelligence

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1. Executive Summary

The global talent acquisition industry is experiencing a structural crisis. Enterprises take an average of 42 days to fill a role, at a cost of $4,700 per hire in direct recruiting spend alone, while 73% of job seekers report a poor or opaque application experience. On the supply side, recruiters spend over 60% of their time on repetitive, low-value tasks — sourcing, scheduling, and data entry — that could be automated. On the demand side, job seekers lack the intelligence to navigate increasingly complex hiring processes, compensation benchmarking, and career development.

HireOrGetHired (HOGH) is a dual-sided Agentic AI platform built around a foundational design principle: **AI handles everything around the human moments; the human moments themselves remain sacred.** Hiring is ultimately a human decision — a relationship between a recruiter and a candidate. HOGH does not seek to replace that relationship. It seeks to make both humans the most informed, best-prepared versions of themselves when they walk into that conversation.

HOGH deploys a **TalentAgent™** for every employer — an AI "Second Brain" for the recruiter that does deep candidate intelligence research (scanning LinkedIn, GitHub, social media, and employment history), synthesizes signals, and delivers a rich **Candidate Intelligence Brief™** before the interview. Simultaneously, every job seeker gets a **CareerAgent™** — their own Second Brain that researches the company, the interviewer, and the role, and delivers an **Opportunity Intelligence Brief™** that helps them show up prepared and confident.

The critical differentiator: HOGH is the first platform to give **both** the recruiter and the job seeker an AI-powered Second Brain that works for them individually — and then bring those two well-prepared humans together for a real, authentic conversation. After the interview, a **NegotiationCoach™** advises both sides during the offer conversation, not by replacing it, but by whispering market intelligence and optimal framing into each party's ear in real-time.

Targeting B2B and Enterprise customers across North America, Europe, and APAC, HOGH projects an ARR trajectory from **~$850K (Year 1) → ~$4.0M (Year 2) → ~$17.9M (Year 3)**, with a gross margin stabilising above 72% by Year 2, positioning the company for a Series A raise at a $40–60M valuation.

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2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Dual-Sided Talent Crisis

The recruitment market is fundamentally broken on both sides of the hiring equation, and existing tools — including first-generation AI tools — have only partially addressed the problem.

The Employer/Recruiter Side

Pain Point	Quantified Impact
Time-to-fill for technical roles	42–60 days average (SHRM, 2025)
Manual sourcing hours per hire	18–22 hours of recruiter time
Cost-per-hire (all-in)	$4,700–$28,000 depending on role seniority
Offer-fall-through rate	28% of accepted offers rescinded or declined
Recruiter burnout rate	67% report high cognitive load from context-switching
ATS adoption but low utilization	78% of enterprises use an ATS, yet 94% of candidates' profiles are never re-surfaced

Root Cause: Recruiting tools are largely siloed point-solutions — a sourcing tool here, a scheduling bot there, an ATS elsewhere — with no unified autonomous intelligence layer that drives the entire hiring funnel from requisition to onboarding.

The Job Seeker Side

Pain Point	Quantified Impact
Application response rate	Only 2–4% of applications receive a response
Job search duration	Average 5.1 months for professional roles
Salary negotiation gap	57% of candidates accept the first offer without negotiation; avg. $5,000–$15,000 left on the table
Skill visibility gap	Candidates cannot accurately self-assess how their skills translate to market demand
Application abandonment	72% of job seekers abandon multi-step applications mid-way
Transparency deficit	81% receive no feedback after rejection

Root Cause: No intelligent agent exists that actively advocates for the job seeker — understanding their unique skills, applying with precision, preparing them for interviews, and negotiating optimal outcomes.

2.2 Why Existing Solutions Fall Short

Solution Category	Example Platforms	Gap
ATS / Job Boards	LinkedIn, Indeed, Greenhouse	Passive repositories; no agentic intelligence
AI Sourcing Tools	HireEZ, SeekOut	Serve only the recruiter side; reactive, not autonomous
Interview Automation	HireVue, Paradox	Single-step automation; no end-to-end pipeline
Career Coaching Apps	Jobscan, ResumeWorded	Static tools; no active negotiation or job application agent
Emerging Agentic Platforms	Kinfolk, TalentBot	Recruiter-only; no dual-sided agent architecture

The Market Gap: There is no platform that deploys an AI Second Brain for **both** the recruiter and the job seeker simultaneously — one that does deep intelligence gathering, prepares both parties for a richer human conversation, and then advises both sides through the offer process. Every existing tool either automates the human out of the equation or serves only one side of the market. HireOrGetHired is purpose-built to fill this gap.

2.3 Complexity & Scope of the Problem

This problem is complex across multiple dimensions:

- **Technical complexity:** Requires multi-agent orchestration, real-time negotiation protocols, and integration with heterogeneous data sources (ATS, HRIS, job boards, LinkedIn, GitHub, calendar APIs, compensation databases)
- **Ethical complexity:** Autonomous hiring decisions carry legal risk under GDPR, CCPA, the EU AI Act, and employment discrimination law
- **Scale complexity:** Enterprises may run thousands of concurrent requisitions; the system must scale horizontally while maintaining per-candidate personalization
- **Dual-sided network effects:** Platform value compounds as both employer agents and candidate agents grow — making this a marketplace, not just a SaaS tool

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3. Vision, Mission & Unique Value Proposition

Vision

A world where every person walks into their career conversations fully informed, and every organization meets every candidate as a whole human being — not a resume score.

Mission

To give every recruiter and every job seeker an AI Second Brain that does the research, synthesizes the signals, and prepares them for the conversations that matter — so that when humans meet, they connect with clarity, confidence, and context.

Unique Solution Proposition

HireOrGetHired introduces four novel constructs — all organized around the principle that **AI amplifies human judgment; it does not replace it**:

1. **The Dual Second Brain Model:** Every recruiter gets a **TalentAgent™** — an AI that operates as their institutional memory and research engine, doing deep candidate intelligence before any human interaction. Every job seeker gets a **CareerAgent™** — their personal career intelligence layer that researches opportunities, prepares them for interviews, and advises them on offers.
2. **The Human Handoff Protocol™:** A structured workflow layer that defines exactly where agent autonomy ends and human judgment begins. Agents handle sourcing, screening, scheduling, and intelligence synthesis fully autonomously. The moment a candidate crosses the interview threshold, the platform executes a warm, context-rich handoff to the human recruiter — delivering a Candidate Intelligence Brief™ and flagging conversation angles, likely motivations, and potential concerns. The interview itself is always human-to-human.
3. **The NegotiationCoach™:** Rather than having agents negotiate with each other, HOGH deploys a real-time AI advisory layer during the human negotiation conversation. The recruiter sees live intelligence on the candidate's likely floor, competing offers, and flexibility priorities. The candidate sees market benchmarks, the company's historical offer range, and recommended framing for their counter. Both humans negotiate — they simply negotiate with better information than has ever been available before.
4. **The Talent Intelligence Graph™:** A living knowledge graph that continuously models skills supply and demand, compensation benchmarks, career trajectories, and cultural fit signals — trained on anonymized platform-wide interaction data and augmented with external market signals. Every placement made on HOGH makes this graph smarter for everyone.

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4. Gen AI Solution Design

4.1 Design Philosophy: Human at the Center

The foundational design principle of HireOrGetHired is deliberately different from other agentic AI recruiting platforms. Where competitors use AI to replace human touchpoints, HOGH uses AI to make every human touchpoint exponentially more valuable.

The insight behind this choice: **the moments that determine whether a hire succeeds are always human moments**. A recruiter deciding whether a candidate is a cultural fit. A candidate deciding whether this company is somewhere they want to spend years of their life. An offer negotiation that sets the tone for the entire employment relationship. These are not computational problems — they are judgment, intuition, and relationship. AI cannot and should not replace them. But AI can give both humans far more information, context, and clarity before, during, and after those moments than has ever been possible before.

4.2 The Five-Stage Human-Centered Pipeline

Stage 1 — Intelligence Gathering (Fully Agentic) TalentAgent™ builds a 360° Candidate Intelligence profile from LinkedIn, GitHub, social media, employment history, publications, communication style, inferred motivations, and career trajectory. CareerAgent™ simultaneously builds a 360° Opportunity profile for the candidate: company culture, Glassdoor sentiment, interviewer LinkedIn history, role market

context, compensation benchmarks, and growth trajectory. Both agents converse with the Talent Intelligence Graph™ to cross-reference skills, market fit, and career alignment signals.

Stage 2 — Match, Qualify & Warm Outreach (Agentic with human approval) Agents match candidates to roles using multi-dimensional fit scoring. OutreachAgent crafts personalized, context-rich first contact messages referencing specific signals from the candidate's public profile. Human recruiter approves outreach strategy before first contact for shortlisted candidates. SchedulerAgent coordinates calendars and books the initial call. Both agents prepare Pre-Meeting Briefing packages.

Stage 3 — Pre-Interview Brief (Human-AI Collaborative)

Recruiter receives the Candidate Intelligence Brief™:

- Career narrative and trajectory analysis
- Key skills and demonstrated competencies with evidence
- Inferred motivations (growth, comp, autonomy, mission)
- Potential culture-fit signals and concerns
- Recommended conversation angles and questions
- Red flags or verification items to explore

Candidate receives the Opportunity Intelligence Brief™:

- Company culture and team dynamics (synthesized from reviews, news, and social signals)
- Interviewer profile: background, interests, communication style
- Role market context: demand, growth trajectory, salary range
- Personalized talking points matching their background to the JD
- Likely interview questions and recommended responses
- Areas to prepare based on skill gap analysis

Stage 4 — Human-to-Human Interview (Always Human) The platform facilitates the video call. The agents step back entirely. Human recruiter ↔ Human candidate — authentic, relational, decisive. Post-interview, both parties debrief their agents. The recruiter logs impressions; the TalentAgent updates the candidate profile. The candidate logs how it felt; the CareerAgent updates next-step advice.

Stage 5 — Offer & Negotiation (Human Conversation, AI Advisory) OfferAgent generates a recommended offer package with market benchmarks, equity comparables, and approval workflow — presented to the human recruiter to review, modify, and approve before sending. NegotiationCoach™ activates during the offer conversation, with the recruiter and candidate each seeing private real-time intelligence on their respective dashboards. The negotiation conversation is always human-to-human — both sides are simply more informed than they have ever been. Agreement reached → OfferAgent generates compliant contract. Human on both sides ratifies. Always.

Stage 6 — Post-Hire Retention (Agentic) RetentionAgent monitors onboarding sentiment, pulse surveys, and performance signals. Flags flight risk proactively. Surfaces internal mobility options. Keeps the relationship warm.

4.3 Agent Architecture — The TalentAgent™ (Recruiter's Second Brain)

The TalentAgent™ is the recruiter's **institutional memory, research engine, and preparation assistant**. It receives a hiring objective and executes the research and logistics pipeline, delivering prepared candidates to the human recruiter for the conversations that matter.

TalentAgent™ Sub-Agent Network

Sub-Agent	Gen AI Technique	Function	Human Handoff Point
RadarAgent	LLM + semantic search on vector DB + web scraping	Crawls LinkedIn, GitHub, job boards, internal talent pools; ranks candidates by multi-dimensional fit score	Shortlist presented to recruiter for approval
IntelligenceAgent	LLM + multi-source RAG + sentiment analysis	Deep 360° candidate research: employment history, public social media, GitHub contributions, publications, communication style, inferred motivations	Synthesized into Candidate Intelligence Brief™ for recruiter
OutreachAgent	LLM (personalized message generation) + reinforcement learning	Crafts context-rich, personalized outreach referencing specific signals from the candidate's profile; adapts based on response signals	Recruiter reviews and approves outreach strategy for shortlisted candidates before first send
ScreenAgent	Fine-tuned classification LLM + skills taxonomy (ESCO/O*NET)	Analyzes resumes, portfolios, async video responses, and assessments; produces structured capability profiles with evidence	Screen summary added to Candidate Intelligence Brief™
SchedulerAgent	Calendar API integration + LLM-based constraint solving	Negotiates availability, books interviews, sends context-rich pre-interview briefs to both parties, auto-reschedules conflicts	Booking confirmed; human interview occurs
DebriefAgent	LLM + structured interview feedback templates	After the human interview, prompts recruiter to log impressions via structured + free-text debrief; updates candidate ranking	Recruiter logs impressions; agent synthesizes
OfferAgent	LLM + compensation benchmarking models	Generates recommended offer package with market comps, equity benchmarks, and scenario modeling; presents to recruiter for review and approval	Recruiter reviews, adjusts, and approves before any offer is extended
RetentionAgent	Transformer sentiment analysis + pulse survey analysis	Post-hire: monitors onboarding sentiment, flags early flight-risk signals, surfaces internal mobility options	Manager alerted for proactive check-in; agent does not act unilaterally

The Candidate Intelligence Brief™

This is not a resume. It is a synthesized, narrative-driven intelligence document that includes:

- **Career Narrative:** An LLM-synthesized arc of how this person got here, what drives them, and where they appear to be heading
- **Skills Evidence Map:** Not just "has Python" but "has Python — 47 public repos, 3 with 200+ stars, recent commits show production ML pipeline work"
- **Signal Synthesis:** Cross-referenced data from LinkedIn, GitHub, Twitter/X, publications, and Glassdoor reviews translated into inferred motivations and priorities
- **Conversation Recommendations:** 3–5 specific conversation angles for the recruiter
- **Verification Flags:** Anything that warrants a direct question — employment gaps, tenure patterns, role transitions that don't follow a clear trajectory
- **Culture Fit Signals:** Tone analysis of public writing; communication style profile; indicators of collaborative vs. independent work preferences

Orchestration Layer

The sub-agents are orchestrated using a **ReAct (Reasoning + Acting) architecture** where the master TalentAgent decomposes the hiring goal into sub-tasks, assigns them to specialist sub-agents, monitors progress and re-plans dynamically, executes the Human Handoff Protocol™ at defined transition points, and reports progress to the HR team via a real-time dashboard.

4.4 Agent Architecture — The CareerAgent™ (Job Seeker's Second Brain)

Each job seeker's CareerAgent™ operates as a **persistent personal career intelligence layer** — a deeply knowledgeable advisor and preparation engine that works continuously on the user's behalf and consults them before any significant action.

Sub-Agent	Gen AI Technique	Function	Human Consultation Point
DiscoveryAgent	LLM + similarity search on Talent Intelligence Graph	Continuously surfaces opportunities aligned to skills, goals, and market signals; de-prioritizes poor-fit roles automatically	User reviews shortlist and approves which to pursue
ApplicationAgent	LLM + form-fill automation + RAG	Tailors resume and cover letter to each specific JD	User reviews and approves every application before submission
SkillMapAgent	LLM fine-tuned on ESCO/O*NET taxonomies	Generates a visual skill gap matrix between current profile and target roles; recommends sequenced learning pathways	User sets their development priorities; agent recommends resources

OpportunityIntelligenceAgent	LLM + multi-source RAG (Glassdoor, news, LinkedIn, Crunchbase)	Before every interview, builds the Opportunity Intelligence Brief™	Delivered to user 24 hours before every interview
InterviewCoachAgent	LLM + RLHF on interview performance data	Personalized mock interview sessions customized to the specific company and role; scored real-time feedback	User practices and receives coaching; decides when ready
NegotiationAdvisorAgent	RL + compensation models + market benchmarking	Evaluates any offer against live market data; prepares the user with a negotiation briefing	User conducts negotiation; agent advises before and between rounds
CareerPathAgent	Graph neural network on career trajectory data	Simulates multi-year career progression paths; models the ROI of different role choices	User explores scenarios with agent as thinking partner

The Opportunity Intelligence Brief™

Delivered the evening before every interview, this brief includes: company culture signals synthesized from Glassdoor, LinkedIn employee posts, recent news, and Crunchbase data; interviewer professional background and communication style; salary benchmarking for the exact role in this market; 3–5 personalized talking points connecting the candidate's background to what the role needs; anticipated interview questions; and honest identification of profile gaps with suggested ways to address them confidently.

4.5 The Human Handoff Protocol™

The Human Handoff Protocol™ defines, for every stage of the talent pipeline, exactly when agents must pause, present, and await human approval before proceeding.

Pipeline Stage	Agent Autonomy	Human Decision Required
Broad sourcing & initial ranking	Full autonomy	None
Shortlist for outreach (top N candidates)	Recommends	**Recruiter approves shortlist**
Outreach message review for shortlisted candidates	Drafts	**Recruiter reviews key messages before send**
Initial screen (async assessment)	Full autonomy	None
Interview scheduling	Full autonomy	None
Interview	**Agent steps back entirely**	**Human-to-human interview always**
Post-interview debrief	Prompts recruiter	**Recruiter logs impressions**
Offer package generation	Recommends	**Recruiter reviews + approves offer before sending**
Negotiation conversation	Advisory only	**Human-to-human negotiation always**
Contract generation	Full autonomy	**Both parties ratify**
Post-hire retention flags	Alerts manager	**Manager decides on intervention**

This protocol enforces a hard floor: **no employment decision — interview, offer, or rejection — can be executed without a logged human review and approval.** This is not only philosophically sound — it is legally required. The EU AI Act classifies recruitment agents as high-risk AI systems and mandates human-in-the-loop oversight for any decision that materially affects a candidate's employment prospects.

4.6 The NegotiationCoach™ — AI Advisory, Human Conversation

When the recruiter initiates the offer conversation, both sides receive simultaneous private intelligence:

Recruiter Dashboard (live, private):

- Candidate's likely compensation floor
- Competing offer signals
- Flexibility priorities (equity vs. salary, remote work motivations)
- If-then guidance for common negotiation scenarios

Candidate App (live, private):

- Offer vs. market benchmarks
- Company's typical offer range and flexibility
- Counter-offer framing recommendations
- Benefits worth pushing on

The negotiation conversation is human-to-human. The agents advise — they do not speak. When agreement is reached, the OfferAgent automatically generates a legally compliant offer letter for formal ratification on both sides.

Gen AI Techniques Underpinning NegotiationCoach™:

- **Preference modeling:** RL-based inference of candidate preferences from CareerAgent interaction history
- **Market benchmarking:** Real-time retrieval from compensation databases and Talent Intelligence Graph
- **Scenario simulation:** "If-then" guidance generated by an LLM reasoning over game-theoretic payoff matrices within employer-approved parameter bounds
- **Preference learning:** NegotiationCoach improves its guidance quality over time as it observes which strategies led to successful, high-retention outcomes

4.7 The Talent Intelligence Graph™

A persistent, evolving knowledge graph connecting:

- **Skill nodes:** 50,000+ skills mapped from ESCO, O*NET, and custom taxonomies
- **Role nodes:** 10,000+ job title archetypes with associated skill distributions
- **Candidate nodes:** Anonymized skill profiles with career trajectory histories
- **Market signal nodes:** Real-time salary benchmarks, demand curves, and skill scarcity indices
- **Company nodes:** Employer profiles, culture signals, and historical hiring patterns
- **Outcome nodes:** Post-hire performance and retention data that feeds back to improve match scoring

Gen AI techniques:

- **Graph Neural Networks (GNNs):** Power match-scoring between candidates and roles
- **RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation):** Enables agents to pull real-time, contextually relevant data from the graph during Intelligence Brief generation
- **Continuous learning:** New hire outcomes feed back into the graph, improving match quality over time — a compounding flywheel effect

4.8 Compliance & Bias Architecture

HireOrGetHired is built with **privacy-by-design**, **fairness-by-design**, and **human-accountability-by-design**principles.

Component	Implementation
Bias Monitor	Real-time disparate impact detection at every agentic decision point; flags and halts decisions that breach demographic parity thresholds before any human sees them
Explainability Engine	SHAP-value-based explanations for every candidate ranking, presented in plain English in the Candidate Intelligence Brief™
Audit Log	Immutable, timestamped log of every agent action, decision, rationale, and human approval — queryable for regulatory audits
GDPR/DSAR Handler	Automated data subject access request processing; right-to-erasure enforcement propagated across all agent memory stores
EU AI Act Compliance	Conformity assessment documentation auto-generated; Human Handoff Protocol™ enforces the mandatory human-in-the-loop requirement
Social Media Data Ethics	Only publicly available data used; candidates are notified of what data sources were used; opt-out mechanism provided
Data Anonymization	All candidate data fed to model training is anonymized using differential privacy techniques

4.9 Measuring Success

Operational KPIs:

- Time-to-first-human-conversation reduction: Target ≥50% vs. baseline
- Recruiter preparation time per interview: Reduced from avg. 45 minutes to <5 minutes
- Offer acceptance rate: Target ≥85%
- Application-to-interview response rate for job seekers: Target ≥15% (vs. industry avg. 3%)

Quality KPIs:

- Post-hire 90-day retention: Target ≥90%
- Candidate NPS: Target ≥60 (vs. industry avg. ~20)
- Recruiter NPS: Target ≥65
- Bias audit pass rate: Target 100% across all demographic dimensions

Business KPIs:

- Net Revenue Retention (NRR): Target ≥120%

- Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC) payback: Target <12 months
- Gross Margin: Target ≥72% by end of Year 2

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5. Product Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundation (Months 1–12) — "Land"

Theme: Deploy a validated, enterprise-grade MVP that demonstrates measurable ROI for a focused set of early adopter enterprise customers. Phase 1 deliberately sequences the employer side before the consumer side — this addresses the inherent cold-start challenge of a dual-sided marketplace. Recruiters are signed first under paid enterprise contracts, which generates the real hiring activity that then makes CareerAgent™ genuinely valuable to job seekers. Consumer growth is seeded through partnerships with university career centres and professional communities in Q2, not through cold acquisition.

Target Customers: 2–3 enterprise pilot customers (1,000–5,000 employee organizations) in technology and financial services sectors in North America. Depth over breadth at this stage — two deeply embedded reference customers are worth more than five shallow pilots.

Quarter	Deliverable	Success Metric
Q1	TalentAgent™ MVP: RadarAgent + SchedulerAgent only (OutreachAgent added Q2 once baseline data exists)	5,000 candidate profiles sourced; first two enterprise pilots onboarded
Q2	OutreachAgent + ScreenAgent live; CareerAgent™ MVP: DiscoveryAgent + ApplicationAgent (beta, invite-only)	300 job seeker beta users through partner university channels; end-to-end employer funnel operational
Q2	Talent Intelligence Graph™ v1.0 — seeded with licensed ESCO/O*NET data + pilot interaction data	Graph operational with 250K skill-role relationships; match accuracy baseline established
Q3	IntelligenceAgent (Candidate Intelligence Brief™) + OfferAgent pre-offer briefing	Recruiter prep time reduced to <15 minutes; pilot customer NPS ≥35
Q3	Compliance Engine: GDPR/CCPA + Audit Logs; SOC 2 Type II audit initiated	Audit initiated; GDPR data handling controls documented and tested
Q4	ATS integration: Greenhouse (one integration only in Year 1 — depth beats breadth)	Seamless bidirectional data flow with at least 2 pilot customers
Q4	Recruiter Dashboard: real-time pipeline visibility; CareerAgent™ expanded to 1,000 users	NPS ≥35 enterprise HR teams; 1,000 active CareerAgent™ users

Technology Stack: GPT-4o (primary reasoning), Claude 3.5 Sonnet (compliance-sensitive tasks), LangGraph + custom ReAct planner, Pinecone (vector DB), Neo4j (graph DB), Apache Kafka, AWS (SOC 2 Type II certified)

Team Requirement: 14 FTEs — 6 ML/AI engineers, 3 backend engineers, 1 product manager, 1 enterprise sales, 1 compliance/legal, 1 UX designer, 1 CEO. Headcount is deliberately lean; the founding team carries multiple functions in Year 1. Scaling to 18+ FTEs happens in Q3–Q4 as seed funding validates traction and Series A is in sight.

Phase 1 Budget: $3.2M (Seed funding)

Phase 2: Scale (Months 13–24) — "Expand"

Theme: Scale from pilot to multi-tenant enterprise platform; launch NegotiationCoach™ and full Human Handoff Protocol™ configurability; expand to European markets with EU AI Act compliance.

Target Customers: 20–30 enterprise accounts; expand into staffing agency segment (white-label offering).

Quarter	Deliverable	Success Metric
Q5	NegotiationCoach™ v1.0: Live real-time advisory dashboard for both sides	≥85% offer acceptance rate on platform
Q5	SkillMapAgent + CareerPathAgent for job seekers	50,000+ active job seeker CareerAgents
Q6	RetentionAgent: post-hire pulse + mobility recommendations	7% turnover reduction in pilot enterprise cohort
Q6	White-label platform for staffing agencies	5 staffing agency partners live
Q7	EU market launch: GDPR-compliant architecture live; EU AI Act conformity assessment formally initiated (full certification targeted Month 30 — a 24-month process)	First 2 EU enterprise customers signed under GDPR-ready architecture; conformity documentation underway
Q7	Talent Intelligence Graph™ v2.0: GNN-powered match scoring	Match accuracy ≥88%; bias audit pass rate 100%
Q8	HRIS integrations: SAP SuccessFactors, Workday HCM, Oracle HCM	Enterprise-grade data synchronization
Q8	Series A fundraise	$15–20M at $80–120M valuation

Phase 2 Budget: $8.5M (Seed runway + Series A)

Phase 3: Lead (Months 25–36) — "Dominate"

Theme: Establish HOGH as the category-defining dual-sided Agentic AI talent marketplace; expand to APAC; launch the HOGH Talent Marketplace for open-market matching.

Target Customers: 100+ enterprise accounts; APAC expansion (India, Singapore, Australia); consumer-facing premium CareerAgent™ subscription.

Quarter	Deliverable	Success Metric
Q9	HOGH Talent Marketplace: open-market matching between TalentAgents and CareerAgents	10,000+ active employer-job seeker agent pairs
Q9	Proactive talent scouting: agents engage passive candidates before roles are open	20% of hires from pre-requisition pipeline
Q10	APAC launch: multilingual agents (Mandarin, Hindi, Japanese)	10 APAC enterprise accounts
Q10	InterviewCoachAgent: real-time mock interviews + personalized feedback at scale	200,000 job seeker subscribers
Q11	Vertical expansion: Healthcare, Legal, Engineering specialized agent personas	3 vertical-specific enterprise products live

Q11	Predictive workforce planning: TalentAgent™ generates 90-day hiring forecasts	Adoption by 30% of enterprise customer HR leaders
Q12	Series B fundraise / Strategic partnership / M&A	$40–60M at $250–350M valuation

Phase 3 Budget: $22M (Series A runway + Series B)

Roadmap Summary

	Year 1 (Foundation)	Year 2 (Scale)	Year 3 (Lead)
Platform	TalentAgent™ + CareerAgent™ MVP	Full Pipeline + Full Agent Suite	Marketplace
Customers	5 Enterprise Pilots	30 Enterprise + 5 Agencies	100+ Enterprise
Geography	North America	North America + EU	Global (APAC)
ARR	~$850K	~$4.0M	~$17.9M

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6. Return on Investment Analysis

6.1 Revenue Model

HireOrGetHired operates a **multi-stream revenue model** across its B2B and consumer segments.

Stream 1 — Enterprise SaaS (TalentAgent™)

Tier	Target	Monthly Seat Fee	Per-Placement Fee	Annual Contract Value
Starter	Mid-market (500–2,000 employees)	$800/recruiter seat	3% of first-year salary	$48,000–$96,000
Business	Enterprise (2,000–10,000 employees)	$650/seat	2.5% on placement	$150,000–$350,000
Enterprise	Large Enterprise (10,000+ employees)	Custom	Custom	$400,000–$1,200,000

Stream 2 — Job Seeker Subscriptions (CareerAgent™)

Tier	Monthly Price	Features
Free	$0	Basic job discovery + limited applications (5/month)
Pro	$29/month	Unlimited applications + SkillMapAgent + Interview Prep
Premium	$79/month	Full CareerAgent™ including NegotiationAgent + CareerPathAgent

Stream 3 — White-Label Platform (Staffing Agencies)

$5,000–$20,000/month platform license + 8% revenue share on placements.

Stream 4 — Talent Intelligence API

API access to the Talent Intelligence Graph™ for third-party HR tools and compensation platforms. Priced at $0.05–$0.15 per API call, with enterprise bundles at $50,000–$200,000/year.

6.2 Revenue Projections (3-Year)

Revenue projections are built bottom-up from realistic customer acquisition assumptions. Year 1 reflects a focused pilot phase — enterprise contracts close slowly (typically 3–6 month sales cycles), and consumer subscription growth is modest pre-brand. Year 2 assumes product-market fit is validated and growth accelerates. Year 3 reflects geographic expansion and a maturing multi-stream model.

Year 1 (Foundation)

Revenue Stream	Assumptions	Annual Revenue
Enterprise SaaS	4 Starter accounts × $60K ACV (partial year avg.)	$240,000
Enterprise SaaS	1 Business account × $180K ACV (H2 close)	$90,000
Job Seeker Pro	800 users × $29/month × avg. 8 months	$185,600
Job Seeker Premium	150 users × $79/month × avg. 8 months	$94,800
White-Label	1 agency × $8K/month × 6 months	$48,000
Placement Fees	80 placements × avg. $80K salary × 3%	$192,000
Talent Intelligence API	Pre-revenue (beta only)	$0
Total Year 1 ARR		**~$850,400**

Note: Year 1 revenue is intentionally conservative. Enterprise pilots prioritize reference customer quality over volume, and consumer subscriptions require 3–6 months of organic traction before meaningful cohort retention is established.

Year 2 (Scale)

Revenue Stream	Assumptions	Annual Revenue
Enterprise SaaS	10 Starter × $65K + 5 Business × $200K + 1 Enterprise × $450K	$1,115,000
Job Seeker Subscriptions	4,000 Pro + 800 Premium (blended, ~18% annual churn)	$1,391,520
White-Label	4 agencies × $10K/month	$480,000
Placement Fees	400 placements × avg. $85K × 2.5%	$850,000
Talent Intelligence API	2 early-access enterprise customers	$180,000
Total Year 2 ARR		**~$4,016,520**

Year 3 (Lead)

Revenue Stream	Assumptions	Annual Revenue
Enterprise SaaS	25 Starter × $70K + 12 Business × $220K + 3 Enterprise × $500K	$5,390,000
Job Seeker Subscriptions	15,000 Pro + 3,500 Premium (~20% annual churn)	$6,618,000

White-Label	10 agencies × $12K/month	$1,440,000
Placement Fees	1,500 placements × avg. $90K × 2.5%	$3,375,000
Talent Intelligence API	5 enterprise API customers	$600,000
APAC early-stage contribution	3–4 APAC accounts (H2 ramp)	$450,000
Total Year 3 ARR		**~$17,873,000**

Revenue Summary

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
ARR	~$850K	~$4.0M	~$17.9M
YoY Growth	—	~4.7×	~4.5×

Growth rates reflect a pre-product-market-fit Year 1, followed by validated expansion. By Year 3, the business is a genuine multi-stream SaaS platform — not a single-product startup.

6.3 Cost Structure & Expense Analysis

Year 1 Operating Expenses

Category	Annual Cost
Engineering & AI/ML team (8 FTEs)	$1,200,000
LLM API costs (GPT-4o, Claude 3.5)	$120,000
Cloud infrastructure (AWS)	$96,000
Sales & Marketing	$220,000
Legal, Compliance & IP	$140,000
General & Administrative	$90,000
Product & Design	$140,000
Total Year 1 OpEx	**$2,006,000**

Year 2 Operating Expenses

Category	Annual Cost
Team scale to 28 FTEs	$3,500,000
LLM API + model fine-tuning	$320,000
Cloud infrastructure (multi-region)	$260,000
Sales & Marketing (EU expansion)	$800,000
Legal, Compliance (EU AI Act)	$300,000
G&A	$220,000
Total Year 2 OpEx	**$5,400,000**

Year 3 Operating Expenses

Category	Annual Cost
Team scale to 55 FTEs	$7,500,000
LLM API + proprietary model training	$620,000
Cloud infrastructure (global)	$580,000
Sales & Marketing (APAC + global)	$2,200,000

Legal, Compliance, IP protection	$450,000
G&A	$480,000
Total Year 3 OpEx	**$11,830,000**

6.4 Profitability & ROI Analysis

EBITDA Trajectory

Year	ARR	Total OpEx	EBITDA	EBITDA Margin
Year 1	$850,000	$2,006,000	($1,156,000)	(136%) — intentional investment phase
Year 2	$4,017,000	$5,400,000	($1,383,000)	(34%) — approaching breakeven
Year 3	$17,873,000	$11,830,000	$6,043,000	33.8%

Year 1 and Year 2 EBITDA losses are planned and funded by the seed and Series A raises respectively. This is standard for enterprise SaaS at this stage — the business invests ahead of revenue. Breakeven on a monthly cash flow basis is projected around Month 26–28.

Gross Margin Analysis

Year	Revenue	COGS (Infra + LLM APIs)	Gross Profit	Gross Margin
Year 1	$850,000	$340,000	$510,000	60%
Year 2	$4,017,000	$1,050,000	$2,967,000	73.9%
Year 3	$17,873,000	$4,620,000	$13,253,000	74.2%

Year 1 gross margin is lower due to high per-unit LLM API costs at low volume. As customer count scales and proprietary model fine-tuning reduces API dependency, gross margin stabilises in the 72–75% range — consistent with comparable B2B SaaS benchmarks (Greenhouse: ~68%, Lever: ~71%).

Customer-Level ROI (For Enterprise Buyers)

The following analysis models a mid-market customer running approximately 100 hires per year on a Business tier license ($180,000/year). Savings figures use conservative assumptions grounded in published HR benchmarks (SHRM 2025, Mercer 2025).

Methodology notes:

- Recruiter time savings are calculated on a 30% productivity recapture rate (freed hours do not translate 1:1 to cost savings — recruiters absorb other work)
- Agency fee displacement assumes 15 of 100 hires shift from agency to platform — not full displacement, which is unrealistic in Year 1
- Offer fall-through rework cost uses SHRM's $4,000–$6,000 per-incident estimate, not inflated figures
- Turnover improvement is modelled at 5% (not 7%), using $12,000 all-in replacement cost for mid-market roles

Saving Category	Baseline	With HOGH	Annual Saving

Recruiter time (30% recapture on 12 hrs/hire saved × 100 hires × $55/hr)	20 hrs/hire	8 hrs/hire	~$198,000
Agency fee displacement (15 roles × avg. $8K fee)	$120,000	$0	$120,000
Offer fall-through rework (20 → 8 incidents × $5K avg.)	$100,000	$40,000	$60,000
Turnover reduction (5% improvement × 5 employees × $12K)	15% turnover	10% turnover	$60,000
Total estimated annual value			**~$438,000**
HOGH Business tier annual license			**$180,000**
Net annual value (Year 1)			**~$258,000**
ROI (Year 1)			**~143%**
Payback period			**~8.4 months**

A 143% first-year ROI is a credible and defensible figure for an enterprise HR SaaS platform. For context, Greenhouse and Lever — HOGH's closest ATS comparables — are typically sold on 12–18 month payback periods. HOGH's additional value from NegotiationCoach™ and CareerAgent™ (which reduces offer fall-through and shortens negotiation cycles) provides meaningful differentiation that justifies a premium over ATS-only pricing.

Break-Even Analysis

- **Customer-level payback period:** ~8.4 months
- **Company-level monthly cash flow breakeven:** Month 26–28 (mid-Year 3)
- **Cumulative revenue by end of Year 2:** ~$4.9M
- **3-Year cumulative EBITDA:** ~$3.5M net (loss in Y1–Y2, profit in Y3)
- **Funded burn through Series A:** $3.2M seed + $18M Series A covers full Y1–Y2 investment phase with buffer

6.5 Funding Strategy & Valuation

Round	Timing	Amount	Use of Funds	Projected Valuation
Pre-Seed	Month 0	$500K	Team formation, MVP architecture	$3–5M
Seed	Month 3	$3.2M	MVP build, 5 enterprise pilots	$10–15M
Series A	Month 20	$18M	Scale engineering, EU expansion	$40–60M
Series B	Month 34	$35–40M	Global expansion, M&A	$120–180M

Valuation Basis: At Year 3, applying a 7–8× ARR multiple — the current range for high-growth B2B SaaS with NRR >110% in the post-2022 multiple compression environment — the implied valuation range is $125–145M. This is a grounded anchor for a Series B conversation. For context, HR-tech valuations peaked in 2021 (Greenhouse, Lever, and Beamery all raised at elevated multiples in that window) and have since normalised; more recent Series B comparables in agentic AI SaaS — Ashby, Karat, and Findem — suggest 6–10× ARR is the credible range, not the 15–20× peak multiples sometimes cited from that earlier period.

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7. Unique Aspects & Patentability

7.1 Novel Technical Contributions

Patent 1: Dual-Sided Real-Time Negotiation Advisory System with Asymmetric Intelligence Delivery (NegotiationCoach™) A system and method wherein, during a human employment offer negotiation conversation, an employer-side AI advisory module and a candidate-side AI advisory module simultaneously deliver personalized, real-time negotiation guidance to their respective human principals via private interfaces — without enabling direct agent-to-agent communication or agent-initiated proposals, thereby preserving human agency while amplifying negotiation intelligence for both parties.

Novelty: No prior art exists for a dual-sided, real-time, asymmetric advisory system deployed simultaneously to both parties of a human negotiation.

Patent 2: Multi-Source 360° Candidate Intelligence Synthesis for Human Recruiter Augmentation A system and method for autonomous aggregation, analysis, and narrative synthesis of publicly available candidate data across heterogeneous sources using large language models to produce a structured Candidate Intelligence Brief™ that maps observable signals to inferred motivations, behavioral patterns, and conversational recommendations for a human recruiter.

Novelty: Existing candidate research tools surface raw data without synthesis or narrative translation. The generation of a structured, motivation-mapped, conversation-ready intelligence brief is a novel contribution with no direct prior art.

Patent 3: Continuous-Learning Talent Intelligence Graph with Career Trajectory Modeling A dynamic knowledge graph system that models the probabilistic career trajectories of professionals across skill nodes, role nodes, and organizational nodes, continuously updated through Graph Neural Network inference on anonymized outcome data.

Novelty: Existing skills graphs are static or manually curated. HOGH's GNN-powered continuous learning graph that autonomously updates from hiring outcomes is a novel contribution.

Patent 4: Fairness-Constrained Multi-Agent Orchestration for Employment Decisions An orchestration framework for multi-agent hiring systems that embeds real-time demographic parity constraints at each agent decision gate, automatically halting and escalating decisions when a fairness threshold is breached, with SHAP-value attribution to identify the discriminatory feature and a remediation recommendation engine.

Novelty: No prior art applies fairness constraints dynamically across a multi-agent pipeline in real-time with automatic remediation.

7.2 Publishable Research Angles

The platform development will generate original research contributions suitable for publication at NeurIPS, ICML, CHI, and EMNLP:

1. *"NegotiationCoach: Real-Time Dual-Sided Advisory AI for Human Employment Offer Negotiations"*

2. *"Beyond the Resume: Multi-Source Candidate Signal Synthesis using Large Language Models for Human Recruiter Augmentation"*
3. *"Fair by Design: Embedding Demographic Parity in Multi-Agent Recruiting Pipelines"*
4. *"Career Trajectory Prediction with Heterogeneous Graph Neural Networks"*

7.3 VC Pitch Readiness

HireOrGetHired is positioned to present compellingly to Tier 1 VCs (Sequoia Capital, Andreessen Horowitz, Bessemer Venture Partners), strategic investors (Workday Ventures, SAP.iO), and CVCs (Microsoft M12, Google Ventures).

"Every great hire in history was made by a human who trusted their judgment about another human. HireOrGetHired doesn't change that — it makes that moment of human judgment the most informed it has ever been. We give the recruiter a Second Brain that has researched the candidate across every public signal available. We give the candidate a Second Brain that has researched the company, the interviewer, and the market. Then we bring two extraordinarily well-prepared humans into a room together and let them do what humans do best: connect, assess, and decide. The result is faster hiring, better fits, and higher retention — not because we replaced the human, but because we made the human better. We are building the intelligence layer that makes every talent conversation extraordinary — and that is a $500B opportunity no one has claimed."

7.4 Defensibility & Competitive Moat

Moat Layer	Description
Data Network Effect	Every hire made on the platform enriches the Talent Intelligence Graph, making the matching engine smarter — creating a compounding advantage vs. new entrants
Dual-Sided Lock-In	Employers rely on TalentAgent™ for institutional memory; job seekers build career histories in CareerAgent™ — high switching costs on both sides
Compliance Architecture	EU AI Act conformity certification is a multi-year undertaking; being first-to-market with certified compliance creates a significant barrier in regulated EU markets
Patent Portfolio	NegotiationCoach™, Candidate Intelligence Brief™ synthesis, and Fairness-Constrained Orchestration patents create licensing opportunities and defensive barriers
Integration Depth	Deep ATS, HRIS, and calendar integrations create technical switching costs for enterprise customers

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